ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR (DESKTOP + WEB BETA)

STAINED-GLASS PATTERN: THE BIG PICTURE

GLASSWORKS LLC · ENHANCE MY ART

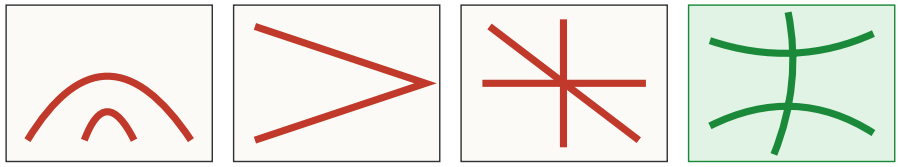
VALUE FOR YOU ★★★★★

Desktop on the-box (main) · Illustrator on the web = beta

PAPER SKETCH → CUTTABLE VECTOR PATTERN

1. **Sketch**
   black marker = lead lines
   every piece a closed shape
2. **Scan / shoot**
   Photoshop Threshold (02)
   pure black + white
3. **Place**
   File > Place
   lock it on its own layer
4. **Image Trace**
   Window > Image > Trace
   settings on page 2
5. **Expand**
   Object > Expand
   now real paths
6. **Live Paint**
   Object > Live Paint > Make
   click pieces to color
7. **Size + print**
   real-size artboard
   page 4 + Acrobat (07)

GLASS-CUT RULES YOUR PAPER SKETCH SHOULD FOLLOW



✖ **DEEP INSIDE CURVE**
glass snaps: split it in 2

✖ **NEEDLE POINT**
thin tips crack: blunt them

✖ **MANY LINES, 1 POINT**
max 3 lines meet; stagger them

✔ **LINES FLOW THROUGH**
gentle curves edge to edge

WHY VECTOR?

Vector lines stay razor sharp at **any size**: same file prints a 6 in suncatcher or a 6 ft window. Pieces become shapes you can count, number and price.

ILLUSTRATOR ON THE WEB (BETA)

Fine for viewing and small fixes on another computer. Do the real pattern work in **desktop** Illustrator on the-box.

AI HELPERS = IDEA STARTERS ONLY

Text to Vector Graphic and **Generative Recolor** use Firefly models. Use them to explore color, but your **own sketch** stays the design.

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IMAGE TRACE SETTINGS THAT WORK FOR LEAD LINES

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IMAGE TRACE PANEL (click the ▸ Advanced arrow)

SETTING	START AT	IF…
Mode	**Black and White**	-
Threshold	128	lines break up → raise to 160-190
Paths	40-50%	lines look lumpy → lower
Corners	25-40%	points get rounded → raise
Noise	25-50 px	pencil specks traced → raise
Method	**Abutting**	-
Ignore White	**ON ✔**	white pieces fill solid → turn on
Preview	ON	turn OFF while tweaking big scans (faster)

THEN CLEAN UP

1. **Expand**
   Object > Expand
   trace → editable paths

2. **Fewer points**
   Object > Path > Simplify
   smooth, cuttable curves

3. **Smooth spots**
   Smooth tool (under Pencil, N)
   drag along a lumpy line

4. **Close gaps**
   Direct Selection (A) + Ctrl+J (join)
   every piece must close

BEFORE / AFTER AT A GLANCE

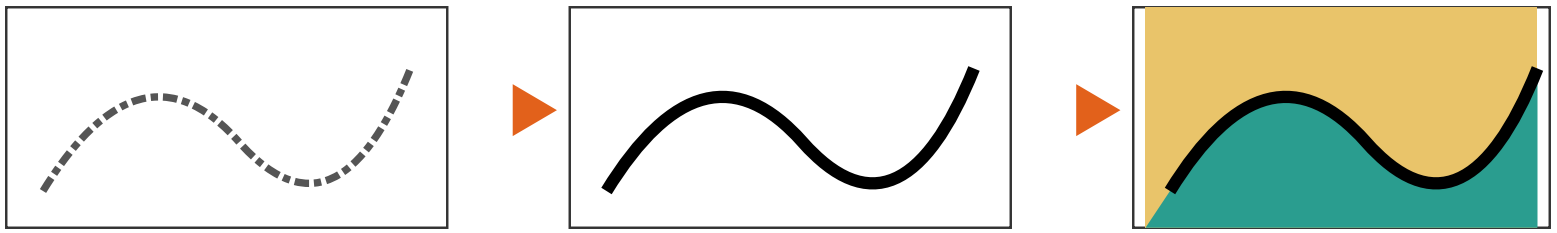


PHOTO: grey, broken ▸ **TRACED + EXPANDED** ▸ **LIVE PAINTED**

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR (DESKTOP + WEB BETA)

LIVE PAINT = INSTANT GLASS + LEAD-LINE WIDTHS

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COLOR EVERY PIECE IN MINUTES

1. **Select all**
   Ctrl+A
   the traced lines
2. **Make Live Paint**
   Object > Live Paint > Make
   (Alt+Ctrl+X)
3. **Load glass colors**
   Swatches from your Adobe Color library (08)
   your real glass stock
4. **Bucket**
   Live Paint Bucket (K) →
   click pieces
   arrow keys switch swatch
5. **Leaky piece?**
   Object > Live Paint > Gap Options
   close small gaps
6. **Try palettes**
   Edit > Edit Colors > Recolor Artwork
   or Generative Recolor

LEAD / FOIL LINE → STROKE WEIGHT (at 1:1 real size)

CAME / FOIL	INCHES	STROKE (pt)
Copper foil seam (soldered)	~1/16 in	4.5 pt
Narrow lead came	1/8 in	9 pt
Standard lead came	3/16 in	13.5 pt
Wide lead came	1/4 in	18 pt
Border / perimeter came	3/8 in	27 pt
Formula	inches x 72	= points

RECOLOR TRICKS

Recolor Artwork

Edit > Edit Colors > Recolor Artwork

Spin the color wheel to test moods without re-clicking every piece.

Generative Recolor

in the Recolor panel (Firefly)

Type a mood: "cathedral amber + cobalt dusk". Pick one, then swap to your real glass swatches.

Global swatches

double-click swatch → Global

Change 1 glass color, every piece using it updates.

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PATTERN PIECES, REPEATS + PRINTING

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FROM ART TO CUTTING PATTERN

1. **Real-size artboard**
   File > Document Setup / Artboard tool (Shift+O)
   e.g. 24 x 36 in
2. **Lock the look**
   Object > Live Paint > Expand
   colors become shapes
3. **Separate pieces**
   right-click → Ungroup (repeat)
   1 shape = 1 glass piece
4. **Number them**
   Type tool (T), small numbers
   add a color-code letter: A12
5. **Cut allowance**
   Object > Path > Offset Path
   minus half the came heart, test first
6. **Save PDF**
   File > Save As > Adobe PDF
   print it in Acrobat (07)

EXTRA POWER MOVES

REPEATING BORDERS

Object > Pattern > Make

Tile a motif for borders or transom strips.

MIRROR DESIGNS

Reflect tool (O) + Alt-click center

Draw half a window, mirror the rest.

PIECE COUNT

Window > Document Info → Objects

How many pieces = labor estimate for quotes.

CLIENT MOCKUP

export PNG → Photoshop

Drop the design into a photo of the client's window.

QUOTE FASTER (GLASSWORKS LLC)

Pieces x minutes per piece + square feet per glass color = a price sheet. Keep a template .ai with your swatches, title block and logo.

SIGN THE DESIGN

Add a small title block: design name, date, "Design: Ely Poprafsky, Glassworks LLC". Add Content Credentials in guide 10.